

patible with 4x, but there is no point in buying an 8x card if you cannot use it to its full potential.

Q The specs of my PC are as follows: Athlon XP 2400+, 256MB PC133 DDR RAM (Hynix) and a Krypton C18G-400 motherboard with onboard nVidia Geforce 4. Recently, my friend accidentally dropped my RAM module. But there were no cracks or scratches. From then on, while launching some applications or games, it shows an error—“(appname).exe has encountered an a problem and needs to close.”

When I viewed the technical contents of this report, it displayed, “The following files will be included:

D:\DOCUME~1\SIVASU~1\LOCALS~1\Temp\WER6.tmp.dir00\gta-vc.exe. mdmp.

D:\DOCUME~1\SIVASU~1\LOCALS~1\Temp\WER6.tmp.dir00\apcompat.txt”

For each application, only the number after “WER” and the application name itself changes. It happens mostly when launching GTA:Vice City, Colin McRae Rally 2, Adobe Live Motion and PDF-to-HTML converter. Is it due to my Hynix RAM? Do I need to get it replaced (it is within the warranty period)? Are there any tools to detect damaged RAM modules?

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A To test whether your RAM is damaged, remove all RAM modules from their slots and insert only one of them into a slot. Now run any the following utility: <http://www.memtest86.com/> or get the Microsoft utility at: <http://oca.microsoft.com/en/winddiag.asp> If you get an error, run the test again with your RAM chip in a different slot. If you do not get an error this time, then your RAM slot is not faulty. Repeat the test for all the RAM chips you have. It may turn out that both your RAM slots are faulty. To make sure that it is your RAM chip at fault, test it on another machine where the slots are working fine. If you do not get any memory errors, then your RAM chip is fine and you should try reinstalling your games and software and updating them with the latest patches.